Benefits Guide

Internal draft - approval required before employee use

Effective date: Pending approval

Policy owner: People Operations

1. Guide Overview

This guide summarizes Northstar Labs benefit programs. Formal plan documents, insurance contracts, and required notices control if they differ from this summary. People Operations can explain enrollment processes but does not provide personal medical, tax, legal, or investment advice.

2. Eligibility

A regular full-time employee scheduled to work at least 30 hours per week is eligible for company-sponsored medical, dental, vision, basic life, disability, retirement, and wellness programs, subject to each plan's terms. Temporary workers and independent contractors are not eligible unless a written plan document states otherwise.

Coverage generally begins on the first day of the calendar month after the employee completes 30 calendar days of employment. If the 30th day falls on the first day of a month, coverage begins on the first day of the following month. The enrollment system displays the employee's actual coverage date.

Eligible dependents generally include a legal spouse or qualifying domestic partner and dependent children through the plan's age limit. Employees must provide accurate eligibility information and report a dependent's loss of eligibility within 30 days.

3. Enrollment and Changes

Newly eligible employees must complete enrollment within 30 days after the eligibility notice. Employees who take no action receive only any company-paid default coverage described in the enrollment system.

After the new-hire window, changes normally may be made during annual open enrollment or within 30 days of a qualifying life event. Marriage, divorce, birth, adoption, and loss of other coverage are common qualifying events. The plan administrator decides whether submitted documentation establishes a qualifying event.

4. Health and Welfare Programs

4.1 Medical, Dental, and Vision

Northstar Labs offers medical, dental, and vision plan choices through designated carriers. Employee contributions vary by plan and coverage tier and are displayed in the enrollment system. Network rules, deductibles, copayments, covered services, exclusions, and claims procedures are controlled by the carrier documents.

4.2 Life and Disability Coverage

The company provides basic employee life insurance and short- and long-term disability coverage for eligible employees. Optional supplemental coverage may require evidence of insurability. Beneficiary designations must be maintained in the enrollment system.

4.3 Wellness and Employee Support

Eligible employees have access to an employee assistance program and a company wellness allowance under the terms published in the benefits portal. Emergency or clinical care should be obtained from an appropriate provider; the internal service channel is not an emergency resource.

5. Retirement Plan

Eligible employees may enroll in the Northstar Labs retirement plan under the plan document's entry and contribution rules. Employees select their own contribution rate and investments through the recordkeeper. The recordkeeper, not People Operations, provides account balances and transaction history.

Company contributions, vesting, loans, withdrawals, and distribution rules are governed by the formal plan document. Northstar Labs does not recommend an individual contribution rate or investment selection.

6. Leave and Benefits Continuation

An employee taking approved paid parental leave remains enrolled in active benefits on the same terms as an actively working employee during the paid 12-week leave, provided the employee continues any required employee contributions. The Leave and Time Off Policy defines the 12-month service requirement, request timing, and coordination with other leave.

Other paid or unpaid leaves may affect payroll deductions and benefit continuation differently. People Operations will provide an individual written notice when a leave changes premium payment, coverage, or continuation rights.

7. Ending Coverage and Continuation Rights

Coverage generally ends on the last day of the month in which eligibility ends, unless a plan document requires a different date. Eligible employees and dependents will receive information about any continuation rights required by law.

Employees leaving Northstar Labs should update their personal contact information so benefit and tax notices reach them. People Operations cannot extend coverage outside the plan or applicable law.

8. Benefit Contacts

Question	Primary contact
Eligibility or enrollment event	People Operations
Claims, networks, or covered services	Insurance carrier
Retirement balance or investments	Retirement recordkeeper
Payroll deductions	People Operations
Urgent medical need	Appropriate medical provider or emergency service

9. Administration

Northstar Labs may amend or end a benefit program, subject to plan terms and applicable law. People Operations coordinates employee communications and retains enrollment records. Employees are responsible for reviewing confirmations and reporting an apparent error promptly.